The Book of Mormon (PG-13 Version)

By Trey Parker, Robert Lopez and Matt Stone

SUGGESTED BREAK DOWN OF CHARACTERS SHOWN BY (1) or (2) for characters other than Elder Price (1) and Elder Cunningham (2)

Actor 1: *Narrator, Voice, Elder Price, Lion King Character, Nabulungi, Middala, Sadaka, Mutumbo, Mission President, The General, Ugandan 2*

Actor 2: *Mormon, Jesus, Moroni, Elder Cunningham, Mafala, Kalimba, Joseph Smith, Ugandan 1*

NOTE: This cutting asks each student to portray multiple characters, which is permissible for Nationals and SOME states. It may not meet the rules requirement for DUO in your state! Be sure to check your STATE rules before performing at local tournaments.

NARRATOR (1): **(Pg 1)** Long ago, in the year of our Lord 326 AD, a great prophet is leader of the Nephite people in ancient Upstate New York. His name . . . is Mormon.

MORMON (2): I am Mormon. My people sailed here from Israel to create a new civilization. These golden plates tell of our people and how we met . . . with Jesus Christ. *(Christ appears to Mormon)*

JESUS (2): I am Jesus. Take care of your golden plates, Mormon, for soon, your entire civilization will be gone and nobody will remember you. *(Christ leaves)*

NARRATOR (1): Just before the Nephite people were wiped out, Mormon gave the plates to his son, Moroni.

MORONI (2): I am Moroni, the last of my kind. I shall bury the golden plates, father, and perhaps one day, someone very special will find them . . .

NARRATOR (1): And lo, Moroni buried the golden plates high on a hill. Centuries later the golden plates were found, giving birth to the fastest growing religion today! A church that sends missionaries out . . . All over the world . . .

Elder Price, a young missionary in a white shirt and black tie, holding the book of Mormon

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pantomimes ringing a doorbell (Ding Dong)

ELDER PRICE: Hello! My Name is Elder Price, and I would like to share with you the most amazing book.

ELDER CUNNINGHAM: **(Pg 4)** Hello! My Name is Elder Cunningham. Would you like to change religions, I have a free book written by Jesus!

VOICE (1): No, No, Elder Cunningham! That's NOT how we do it. You're making things up again. Just stick to the approved dialogue.

ELDER CUNNINGHAM: Hello! My Name is Elder Cunningham, and we would like to share with you this book of Jesus Christ.

PRICE AND CUNNINGHAM: You simply won't believe how much this book will change your life!

INTRODUCTION

ACTOR 1: *The Book of Mormon*
ACTOR 2: *by Trey Parker, Robert Lopez and Matt Stone*

VOICE (1): **(Pg 5)** Elders, you have been training for three months and you are now . . READY TO GO OUT AND SPREAD THE WORD! In a moment you will be assigned your mission companions and locations!

ELDER PRICE: *(to audience)* The most important time of a Mormon kid's life is his mission. I know my mission will be something incredible.

VOICE (1): **(Pg 9-10)** Elder Price? Your brother will be . . . Elder Cunningham!

ELDER CUNNINGHAM: That's! That's ME! *(He struts to Price and gives a big dorky wave)* HELLO!!!!! *(Price is less than enthused)*

VOICE (1): And your mission location is . . . UGANDA!!!!! *(Price looks visibly upset.)*

ELDER CUNNINGHAM: UGANDA! COOL! WHERE IS THAT?!

VOICE (1): AFRICA!

ELDER CUNNINGHAM: Oh BOY – Like Lion King!

LION KING CHARACTER (1): **(Pg 13)** Hey Na Da Hey Na! Aya Bubbu Taya Tayaaaaaaaaa!

VOICE (1): **(Pg 11)** Alright Elders, go home and pack your things! Tomorrow, your missions

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begin! *(Price looks a little uncomfortable. Cunningham looks thrilled)*

******* The boys arrive in Uganda *******

The boys enter. They look around in horror at the poverty they see.

MAFALA (2): **(Pg 17-18)** *(Big and happy)* AHHH! There you are! I have been looking for you! I am Mafala Hatimbi. I've been hired to show you to your building.

ELDER PRICE: Oh, thank goodness! Some men took our bags!

MAFALA (2): In this part of Africa, we ALL have a saying – whenever something bad happens, we just throw our hands up to the sky and say HASA DIGA EEBOWAI!

ELDER CUNNINGHAM: Hasa Diga Eebowai?

MAFALA (2): It's the only way to get through all these troubled times. There's war, famine . . . but having a saying makes it all seem better . . . . There's isn't enough food to eat.

UGANDAN (1): Hasa Diga Eebowai!

MAFALA (2): People are starving in the street.

UGANDAN (1): Hasa Diga Eebowai!

ELDER CUNNINGHAM: Does it mean no worries for the rest of our days?

MAFALA (2): Kind of! We've had no rain in several days.

UGANDAN (1): Hasa Diga Eebowai!

MAFALA (2): And eighty percent of us have aids.

UGANDAN (1): Hasa Diga Eebowai!

ELDER PRICE: **(Pg 19)** Excuse me, what EXACTLY does that phrase mean?

MAFALA (2): Well, let's see . . "Eebowai" means "God", and "Hasa Diga" means *(whispers behind a closed hand)*

ELDER PRICE: WHAT???

ELDER CUNNINGHAM: *(chanting and dancing)* Hasa diga Eebowai! Hasa diga Eebowai! Hasa diga Eebowai! *(continues)*

ELDER PRICE: **(Pg 22)** *(overlapping)* Elder Cunningham. Elder Cunningham. Stop – Don't say it! It means something very bad. *(whispers behind a closed hand)*

ELDER CUNNINGHAM: Holy Moly! I said it like thirteen times!

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***** Mafala's daughter takes the boys to their living quarters *****

NABULUNGI (1): **(Pg 22-23)** This is where my father asked me to bring you. The others like you should be inside.

ELDER CUNNINGHAM: Thank you, Jon Bon Jovi.

ELDER PRICE: *(giving Cunningham a look)* We appreciate your help, Nabulungi. Look, uh, maybe sometime, Elder Cunningham and I could . . . Sort of tell you a little about the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-Day Saints.

NABULUNGI (1): I have to get back to the village. But I am always there – if you want to talk to me. *(She turns to go but then turns back)* Just one piece of advice. No matter how hot you get at night, keep your windows closed. It is the only way to protect against the scorpions. And the mosquitoes. And the lions. And the murderers and the AIDS and the safari ants which plant their eggs under your skin and eat you from the inside out. *(She walks away-the boys respond non-verbally)*

ELDER PRICE: *(big sigh, wipes his brow)* Oh, man, can you believe this? **(Pg 31)** This is going to be a whole lot harder than we thought.

***** (Sceen change - Later that week in a session with the tribespeople) *****

ELDER PRICE: **(Pg 34-35)** We would like to tell you all about a very special book.

UGANDAN (1): (major disappointment) Awww. . .

NABULUNGI (1): We all have heard of the Bible. People come and tell us about Jesus and him dying for our sins once a year!

KALIMBA (2): They come, tell us the story and then leave. Nothing gets better. Your bible doesn't work.

ELDER PRICE: Those were Christian missionaries. We're Mormons!

NABULUNGI (1): What's the difference?

ELDER PRICE: I'm gonna take you back to Biblical times, 1823. An American man named Joe livin' on a farm in the Holy Land of Rochester New York! *(Cunningham steps forward like he's doing an infomercial, over-acting)*

ELDER CUNNINGHAM: You mean the Mormon prophet Joseph Smith?

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ELDER PRICE: That's right, that young man spoke to God.

ELDER CUNNINGHAM: He spoke to God?

ELDER PRICE: And God said, "Joe, people really need to know that the Bible isn't two parts. There's a part three to the Bible, Joe! And I, God, have anointed you to dig up this part three, which is buried by a tree on the hill in your backyard."

ELDER CUNNINGHAM: Wow, God says, "Go to your backyard and start digging"? That makes perfect sense! **(Pg 36)** Wow! The Bible is actually a trilogy, and Book of Mormon is Return of the Jedi?! I'm interested.

ELDER PRICE: Now, many people didn't believe the prophet Joseph Smith.

JOSEPH SMITH (2): **(Pg 37)** I speak to God all the time and he's told me to head west! So I'll take my part three to the Promised Land. Paradise! On the west coast.

ELDER PRICE: Now, on the way to the Promised Land, Joseph was shot by an angry mob. **(Pg 40)** The Prophet Joseph Smith died. But his followers, they kept heading west. And Brigham Young led them to a sparkling land in Utah they named SALT LAKE CITY. And there the Mormons multiplied! And made big Mormon families!! Alright, now who would like their very own copy of the Book of Mormon?? *(All the Ugandan people look at each other for a beat and then walk away making groans and "blow off" gestures.")*

ELDER CUNNINGHAM: If you order now, we'll also throw in a set of steak knives!

ELDER PRICE: What were you doing?! There's nothing in the Book of Mormon about steak knives!

ELDER CUNNINGHAM: I'm sorry. I actually never read it. It's so boring!

ELDER PRICE: **(Pg 44)** Africa is nothing like The Lion King. *(dejected)* There is nothing I can accomplish here! *(Price walks away. Cunningham is not sure what to do or where to go).*

NABULUNGI (1): **(Pg 46)** There you are! Thank goodness I found you! Where is your friend?

ELDER CUNNINGHAM: *(sadly)* I don't have any friends.

NABULUNGI (1): Please come back to the village. We are ready! We're ready to listen. YOU can lead us. Teach us everything about the Book of Mormon.

******* Scene change – Elder Cunningham is alone, preaching to the Ugandans*******

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(Cunningham is reading from the book of Mormon. He is trying to be a preacher, but really doesn't have what it takes)

ELDER CUNNINGHAM: **(Pg 53)** *(reading with vigor)* And it came to pass that the NEPHITES had gathered together a great number of men! And they did have a number of battles, in which the Nephites did beat the Lamanites and did slay many of them! *(Cunningham seems to finish – the Ugandans just stare at him)* Uh . . . that MEANS . . you know . . . You should . . be NICE to each other or something. **(Pg 54)** Let's skip to another part . . . *(Cunningham turns and flips through the pages)*

MIDDALA (1): THREE HOURS we been listening to him talk about STUPID [STUFF] that happened on the other side of the Earth thousands of years ago! IT has nothing to do with US!

SADAKA (1): That's right! Those "NEPHITES" probably didn't even have AIDS to deal with!

ELDER CUNNINGHAM: UH, SURE THEY DID! SURE THEY DID!! People back then had even WORSE AIDS! *(Everyone quiets down and listens to him)* Yeah! *(Cunningham pretends to look through the Book of Mormon, and then pretends to read from it)* And LO! The Lord said unto the Nephites – I know you're really depressed, with all your AIDS and everything . . . But there is an answer in Christ! *(The Ugandans look surprised, but they are now paying attention)*

NABULUNGI (1): You see?! This book CAN help us!

NARRATOR (CHORUS) (1): **(Pg 58)** You're making things up again, Arnold. You're recklessly warping the words of Jesus!

ELDER CUNNINGHAM: **(Pg 71)** *(with more confidence)* And so, yeah, so then Christ said to the Nephites, "Be strong!" You know?! "Just because Lamanites got big Death Star weapons and stuff doesn't mean they should ruin your lives! There's more of you than there are of them, you know? You should always . . . stand up for yourselves," Christ said.

MIDDALA (1): Jut like the way the Hobbits all stood up to Bringham Young's killers!

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MISSION PRESIDENT (1): **(Pg 75)** *(reading a letter)* Dear Mission President, it is my HONOR to

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inform you that the elders of Uganda District 9 have brought TWENTY NEW MEMBERS into the church . . . and our numbers continue to grow! *(No longer reading)* This is outstanding! [Elder Cunningham] has converted more Africans than any district in the COUNTRY!

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ELDER CUNNINGHAM: (Pg 77) *(reading a letter)* It's AMAZING. The mission president wants to meet ME personally! He's going to give me a MEDAL!

ELDER PRICE: (Pg 80) Well, well . . If it isn't the SUPER MORMON. Tell me how it is that YOU converted ALL those people into Mormons. **(Pg 89-90)** Joseph Smith dying of dysentery? Moroni from the Starship Enterprise? A bunch of made-up stuff *(beat)*

ELDER CUNNINGHAM: *(about to cry)* Boy . . . I really did it this time, huh? I mean . . . I've always been a screw up, but THIS –

ELDER PRICE: Wait a minute . . . You little SNEAK!

ELDER CUNNINGHAM: *(confused)* What?

ELDER PRICE: I thought I could fly in here and change everything. But I made it all about ME. While I was losing faith, you went and did something incredible. . . for a people who were unreachable – but then they were happy and hopeful . . . It doesn't matter if the stories are true or not. That isn't the point . . .

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THE GENERAL (1): There have been RUMORS that the people in this village are uniting to oppose me!

MUTUMBO (1): (Pg 91-92) Yes, we have been shown another way!

THE GENERAL (1): There is ONE LAW you will obey here, and it is MINE!

MIDDALA (1): We believe in something ELSE!

ELDER CUNNINGHAM: Excuse me, everyone . . .

ELDER PRICE: You might as well PUT THAT GUN DOWN BECAUSE IT WILL NOT WORK. And if you do not get out of this village he WILL command the angel Moroni, on the death Star, to unleash the Kraken! Which will then . . . . Uh . .

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ELDER CUNNINGHAM: Which will then – fire Joseph Smith torpedoes from its mouth of Christ!

ELDER PRICE: Oh – don't think he can't do it! *(The General runs off)* We are Latter-Day Saints. ALL of us. Even if we change some things, or break the rules, or doubt that God exists . . . We can still work together to make THIS our paradise.

******* The Ugandans pair up and go door to door spreading the word of Arnol *******

The Ugandans appear wearing white shirts and black ties

MUTUMBO (1): **(Pg 97-98)** Hello! My name is elder Mutumbo! And I would like to share with you the most amazing book!

UGANDAN 1 (2): You've read the book of Mormon . . . Did you know there's more?

UGANDAN 2 (1): Part four! Have you heard the story of our prophet Arnold Cunningham?

ELDER CUNNINGHAM: Hello! We can fully guarantee you that . . . .

TOGETHER: This book will change your life. This book will change your life. This book will change your life. The book of ARNOLD. Hello!

LION KING CHARACTER (1): **(Pg 13)** Hey Na Da Hey Na! Aya Bubbu Taya Tayaaaaaaaaa!

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Trey Parker, Robert Lopez and Matt Stone
ISBN: 978-1557049933
Publisher: Newmarket Press
Date (Month/Year): June 2011

AWARD HISTORY

2012 National Qualifier
2013 National Qualifier
2014 National Qualifier
2015 National Qualifier
2016 National Qualifier
2017 National Qualifier
2020 National Qualifier
2021 National Qualifier
IL State Qualifier
IN State Qualifier
MN State Qualifier

NOTE: See the R-Rated section of the VAULT for our original cutting of this selection.

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